Google Pixel 11

The flagship that bets on feeling useful

Google Pixel phones have always stood apart from the usual flagship race. Instead of chasing the fastest chip or the biggest camera sensor, Google built the Pixel around computational photography, clean Android, and AI-powered features like Night Sight and Magic Eraser. Over the years, each generation has refined that formula rather than reinventing it. The Pixel 11 continues that approach, but this time Gemini takes centre stage, becoming a much deeper part of the everyday experience. The big question is whether those smarter AI features are enough to justify the Rs 89,999 price tag. After using it for nearly three weeks, here's what I found.

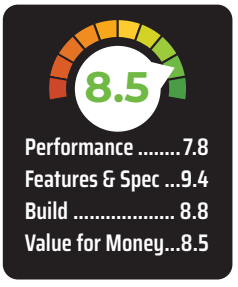


GOOGLE PIXEL 11 DESIGN

Google has not exactly reinvented the Pixel 11's design, and that's probably the point. If you're coming from a Pixel 10, you will have to look twice to spot what's changed. The formula is largely the same: glass on the front and back, a flat aluminium frame and that familiar pill-shaped camera bar that has become a Pixel signature.

There are a few subtle changes: the Pixel 11's camera bar is 40 pct thinner this time around, and Google has ditched the metallic camera frame for an all-glass finish over the camera lenses. It makes the module look a little cleaner. From a distance, it still very much looks like a Pixel.

At 197 grams, the Pixel 11 is lighter than its predecessor, and that difference is noticeable when you use it for hours at a stretch. The compact form factor also makes it comfortable to hold. Personally, this is the kind of size I prefer, and the Pixel 11 gets the ergonomics right.



Durability also looks solid. Google has used Gorilla Glass Victus 2 on both the front and rear, while the phone carries an IP68 rating for protection against dust and water. So, at least on paper, the Pixel 11 should have no trouble dealing with the usual knocks and accidental splashes that come with everyday use.

The glossy rear panel, however, is a different story. It looks sleek when it's clean, but it quickly turns into a fingerprint magnet. It can also get quite slippery without a case, so I'd recommend using one unless you're particularly confident about your grip. The camera module has another minor annoyance: dust tends to collect around it.

PERFORMANCE

Under the hood, the Google Pixel 11 comes with Google's new Tensor G6, built on a 3nm process. Interestingly, it comes with an unusual seven cores compared to the eight core architecture of the Tensor G5 chipset. However, each core is claimed to run at a higher clock speed, up to 4.11Ghz. Google is leaning towards more AI-specific gains rather than raw performance.

In daily use, this phone glides through everything. Apps open quickly, animations stay smooth, and switching between apps never feels jittery. Camera processing is also faster, especially when capturing multiple shots in a row.

The benchmark results gave us a pretty clear picture of the Pixel 11's performance. It scored 12,58,961 on Antutu, while Geekbench returned 1,101 in single-core and 4867 in multi-core. These are decent numbers, but still behind chips like the Snapdragon 8 series and Dimensity 9500 series.

In the 3DMark Wild Life Extreme test, the Pixel 11 scored 3,430, which shows it has enough graphics power for everyday gaming and heavy tasks. Our CPU throttling test showed the chip dropped right after the test started, the graph stayed mostly orange, and the CPU throttled to 60 percent of its peak.

CAMERAS

The Pixel 11 has a triple camera setup with a 48MP main camera at f/1.7 with OIS, a 13MP ultrawide sensor at f/2.2, and a 10.8MP telephoto lens with 5x optical zoom, with Google's Super Zoom pushing that up to 30x digitally for photos. On the front, there's a 10.5MP selfie camera with autofocus.

My colleague took this device on his trip to Kerala, where he took a bunch of camera samples. Looking at them, I can say that the main camera is easily the highlight here. In daylight, photos come out with great contrast, balanced exposure and impressive dynamic range, so bright skies and darker areas are both captured well. Colours look vibrant